



Figure 7: Example of how the shell script pops open the menu widget

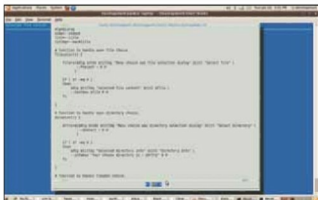


Figure 8: Textbox widget displaying the content of a selected file

```

titlebg--backtitle

# function to handle open file choice.
fileselect() {

    file=$(dialog --title "Menu choice was file selection dialog" \
        --text "Select file" --fileselect -o 0)

    if [ $? -eq 0 ]
    then
        dialog --title "Selected file content" $file --textbox $file 0 0
    fi

# function to handle choose directory choice.
dirselect() {

    directory=$(dialog --title "Menu choice was directory selection dialog" \
        --text "Select directory" \
        --dirselect -o 0)

    if [ $? -eq 0 ]
    then
        dialog --title "Selected directory info" $directory --text "Directory info" \

```

```

        --infobox "Your chosen directory is : $directory" 0 0
    fi
}

# function to handle show textbox choice.
textbox() {

    time=$(dialog --title "Menu choice was Time Box" --text "Select time" \
        --timebox "Choose your favourite time" 0 0)

    if [ $? -eq 0 ]
    then
        dialog --title "Selected time info" $time --text "Time info" \
            --infobox "Your favourite time is : $time" 0 0
    fi
}

# new widget to show various choices.
choices=$(dialog --title "Dialog usage in shell script" --text \
    "Action menu" --menu "Make a choice to proceed" 0 0 \
    1 "Open file" \
    2 "Choose directory" \
    3 "Show textbox" \
    )

# we are interested only in Ok button event.
if [ $? -eq 0 ]
then

# now handle the selected choice.
    if [ "$choice" = "1" ]
    then
        fileselect
    elif [ "$choice" = "2" ]
    then
        dirselect
    elif [ "$choice" = "3" ]
    then
        textbox
    fi
fi

```

Figures 7 and 8 show what happens when you execute the above shell script. Do you see how by using Dialog we turned this otherwise boring text-based shell script into an interactive wizard?

By exploring the concepts we have covered so far and reading the man pages, you can use Dialog widgets in several ways, only limited by your imagination.

Something about Xdialog

Consider Xdialog as an X-based counterpart of Dialog. It refines Dialog widgets further with some extra options and